HDFC in 1978, recalls that they put his photograph in their second balance sheet. Deepak's father, Shantilal, worked for the Central Bank of India in their Rangoon branch where he was the Agent (as the Branch Manager was then called). Deepak narrates the story of how his father was the last man to lock the bank and leave during Second World War. He walked all the way from Rangoon to the Indian border in Assam. It took him three months to complete the trek, the long and arduous journey testimony to his will power, grit, and determination.

Though Deepak was born in Bombay, he spent the first ten years of his life in Rangoon before returning to school in St Xavier's School. He graduated in commerce from Sydenham College and then went to England to do his chartered accountancy doing his articles from Whinney Murray & Co. (now Ernst & Young). S.B. Billimoria & Company which had the audit of the Central Bank of India used to be their Indian associate. After qualifying as a chartered accountant, he worked in New York for a year in the consultancy division of the firm. Never enamoured of settling abroad (even though getting a Green Card was easy in those days), Deepak returned to India with the idea of joining S.B. Billimoria & Company. But S.B. Billimoria, which at one point had the audit of many banks and insurance companies (apart from Tata audits), had lost many clients after the bank nationalization in 1969 and were not hiring. When Deepak met Bhikha Billimoria, son of the founder, he told him: '*Dikra* (son) why did you come back?'[11]

Deepak worked for a company called Precision Fasteners as its Chief Accountant for nine months before joining Grindlays Bank's merchant banking division. (At that time Grindlays Bank was the only bank to have such a division). He worked there for three years and then joined Chase Manhattan in their representative office in Bombay. They sent him to Hong Kong and Singapore for a training programme and on his return Chase wanted to send him to Saudi Arabia on a very attractive salary but Deepak was not keen on going abroad. 'Huge money, huge vacations, two months off in a year but I was not interested.'[12] It was at this time that Parekh was launching HDFC and told his nephew: 'We are doing something new, why don't you join us instead of running all over the world?'[13] Deepak joined as the Deputy General Manager in November 1978 at half the salary he was getting at Chase but never regretted it. Deepak became the Executive